

New 128 GB flash from Toshiba

Toshiba has unveiled a 128 GB NAND flash memory module

Intel for more cache

Intel is looking to increase the amount of cache on their processors once again; cache levels haven't changed much since Core 2 Duo

The thumb buttons add to the beauty of the design, and they're large, therefore easier to use. The mouse buttons exude good feedback. The sides of the mouse have a surface that grips the hand well and resists sweat – a boon. The feet on the Kova feature the same soft-feel Teflon that the Razer mice have. Thanks to this, the Kova has a good balance of grip and slip, although its smaller size can occasionally cause it to behave less than optimally, however, this is something your hands need to adjust to, after using mice like the Mamba. Accu-



Roccat
Kova

racy on Roccat's own Sense mat was very good – great acceleration and a near-perfect mix of grip and slide. The Kova also tracks well on the Destructor, although it tends to slide just a bit more than we'd like it. We feel this is due to the initial resistance when moving the mouse that causes one to put a bit extra effort, once the mouse gets moving, it glides smoothly, almost too smoothly.

The Titan proved stickier, and we found that overtracking was less of a problem as the mouse glide was more controlled and acceleration was also reigned in. Priced at Rs. 4,250, we found the Kova a bit costly, we're told that Roccat is a European company so the costs involved are higher. Regardless, the Kova is a very good mouse, but we feel Razer's and Logitech's designs are designed with a little more comfort in mind.

Razer Orochi

The Orochi has been designed to straddle an interesting divide – notebook users and gamers. After using it as both a gaming mouse and a notebook mouse we feel it's equally suited to both roles, although the fact that it doesn't go all the way in either direction is ultimately its biggest hurdle. The mouse is reasonably well built and suitably compact for notebook purposes. It does get heavy when populated by two AA batteries, but most will not mind, because this gives some much-needed stability. The body of the mouse slopes forward and from a raised rear. This is good because the raised portion fits your palm giving a slightly more substantial in-hand feeling. The mouse can be used wirelessly or with a USB cable that is also bundled. When powered by two AA batteries, the Orochi becomes heavy, but not uncomfortably so, actually the in-hand feel is nice.

Even though its small the mouse fits even medium-large hands well owing to its width and the raised rear. Being a Bluetooth mouse, you save a USB port. The wheel has a nice positive click, as do the buttons, a pity Razer didn't add a tilt feature for the wheel that is invaluable for most users. Scrolling is very accurate gamers will not complain. The feet provide the right balance between slip and traction on good surfaces. On the Destructor the Orochi is very behaved, and mouse acceleration is good. The feet are larger than those on the Mamba and Emperor but made of the same soft-feel Teflon. There are four additional buttons on



Razer Orochi

the mouse – two on the left, two on the right. The ones on the left are useful although not the most ergonomically located; the ones on the right are absolutely useless – and little more than decoration – using them is pretty difficult, especially if you're gaming. Actually, the only reason the buttons are present on the left is that, the Orochi is intended to be ambidextrous – this will be of significance to left-handed gamers.

Overall hardcore gamers will look at bigger mice for better control, while notebook users might want something with more features, making the Orochi an expensive option, (Rs. 4,999), straddling two usage patterns.

MOUSEPADS

Some might question the sanity of buying a discrete gaming mat,

although any gamer worth his DX11 graphic card will scoff at the very notion of using cheap mousepads. Gaming mousepads are usually designed ground up for use with a particular series of mice. The surface is typically larger, since while gaming there's a lot more mouse movement. The surface is also made of special materials that offer the perfect balance between slide and grip, of course this is optimised for a particular type of mouse, as different mice have different feet. If you are wondering whether a gaming mat is for you or not, the answer is simple – if you're serious about gaming and comfort, you'll consider one. It also ensures your pricey mouse gets comfortable shoes for its feet, for poorly designed mats can damage or change the characteristics of the Teflon feet used on mice.

Razer Destructor

Razer is known for making gamers happy, and the Destructor seems like a worthy attempt. It's a deviation from the soft, cloth-based, foam-backed surfaces we're used to seeing. Instead the Destructor has a hard surface that has just enough texture to be termed as "unsmooth". In fact the texture is similar to very fine sandpaper – although it's not abrasive to your fingertips. There is a thin layer of soft rubber on the rear side of the hard surface, and this provides excellent grip – the mat will not slide on the table, no matter how hard you try. The mat ships in a fancy, rigid zipper case that should easily protect it from most wear and tear.

While testing we couldn't help but notice how wide this mat is – great for gaming, where mouse movements are erratic and sudden and the travel distance is a lot. Tracking is very, very accurate, and this is not something limited to Razer mice. We found even Logitech's MX 518 and G500 gaming mice tracked wonderfully on this surface, although coming from a cloth-weave-based gaming mat you'll need to adjust to the relatively higher acceleration and slightly lower initial resistance that the surface provides. However, accuracy is not sacrificed over speed making the Destructor a truly killer prospect for the competition. We also tried Razer's own Mamba and Emperor mice on the Destructor, and are pleased to report very good results. The slightly harder Teflon feet on the Deathadder are not as conducive to the slide on the Destructor, but the Mamba and the Emperor glide effortlessly, and despite the slickness there's accuracy when you want it.